DAYSTAR

Family Life Ministries

PLEASE READ THIS:

JUST BEFORE YOU SAY I DO

Attn: All intending Couple- Make sure you adopt '**PATSON**'

1. **Proposal must be made with a pastoral consent**

2. **Attendance of the courtship classes is compulsory for all intending couples**

3. **The church should be notified of all relationships by the filling of the required forms**

4. **Sex before marriage is prohibited and must not be compromised**

5. **Only registered members of the Church will be joined in marriage**

6. **Notification of at least six [6] months to the church is required by all intending couple**

Note: ***where a Daystar Sister has been proposed to by a brother outside the church, she should immediately notify the Pastor for Membership upon acceptance or vice versa if it's a Brother.***

BEFORE YOU SAY I DO:

What you need to know about Daystar Marriage Mentoring Program [MMP]

STEPS:

1. **Pick a Courtship form at the information desk/church office reception and return same with one (1) passport photographs of the intended couple.**
2. **Get started with your supervising Counselor as assigned by the Family Life Ministries of the church.**
3. **Get through the 15[fifteen] initial counseling sessions with the supervising Counselor.**
4. **Seek approval for marriage notification of at least three months to the senior pastor**
5. **Get through the marriage processes and procedures (traditional/registry/church weddings ceremonies) with the aid of supervising counselors.**
6. **Get through the wedding ceremony procedures as agreed with your family.**
7. **Organize the wedding service as well as the reception with the cooperation of the membership team as deemed fit.**
8. **Take advantage of post marital mentoring processes of the family life ministries of the church.**
9. **Take the responsibilities and the initiatives apply the thing you have learnt during your counseling sessions as well as develop mentoring relationship with those who have proven marriages based on biblical principles.**

Take note please : when writing your wedding notification letter (after the 8th class) to the church, ensure to give your counselor to sign after both parties (counselee) must have signed, Please attach a photocopy of your membership certificate to the wedding notification at the point of submission.

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GUIDELINE ON COURTSHIP/MARRIAGE

Note: A member of Daystar is one who has completed at least the membership school(MS) in the Daystar academy.

1.0 GENERAL RULES AND REGULATIONS

- **1.1 A sister going into marriage should not be less than 21 years of age**
- **1.2 Courtship and dating before new birth should be discontinued**
- **1.3 Courtship should be within 9 months and 3 years from the date of approval of the courtship by the family life ministries**
- **1.4 Under no circumstances should courtship proposal be made without prior notification and approval of supervising Pastor.**
- **1.5 A brother is expected to make the proposal and not the sister**
- **1.6 Where a Daystar sister has been proposed to by a brother outside the church , she should immediately notify the pastor (family life ministries) upon acceptance**
- **1.7 The supervising counselor should be notified before a relationship is discontinued.**
- **1.8 Intending couple must have parental consent before fixing their wedding date and other marriage procedure, where there is difficulty; the face of the Lord must be sought for favor.**
- **1.9 They should not engage in premarital sex. This is fornication, it erode trust; hence, they should not sleep in the same room within or without where they are based nor visit at odd hours of the night as this can stimulate uncontrolled and illicit passion (1corithians 6:18-20)**
- **1.10 During courtship, issues like past marriages, children there have been, should be disclosed to each other and the supervising counselor.**
- **1.11 No one is allowed courtship relationship with an unsaved person. It cannot work as you can't save the other person. DO NOT BE UNEQUALLY YOKE(2Corinthian 6:14-16)**
- **1.12 A brother should not engage in courtship with more than a sister at the same time and vice versa**
- **1.13 Any courtship entered into without the approval/blessing of the family life ministries will not be recognized by the church and both parties will face consequences of their unapproved actions.**
- **1.14 In the case of a sister pregnant, among other sanctions, the Pastor shall not join them in Holy matrimony and shall not be involved in the issue relating to the wedding ceremonies until the baby is born. They shall both bear full responsibility for their action as agreed with their families.**

2.0 GENERAL CONDUCT OF COUPLE IN COURTSHIP

- **2.1 They are not yet married and so they are expected to conduct themselves in a manner that Excludes the appearance of all evil reports, they should be an example 1Thessalonian 5:22**
- **2.2 They should pray and plan together towards their future home. Be able to capture the future as promise in God's word. However, this should not be done at odd hours of the day**
- **2.3 They should have health fellowship through sharing the word and fasting and other commendable spiritual exercise in preparation for their new home**
- **2.4 They should maintain healthy communication among themselves and others who may not be in courtship Eph 4:49**
- **2.5 The general attitude of the intending couple should be that of care, love concern and mutual respect towards each other and honor to God (Hebrew 13:4)**
- **2.6 They should develop trust and confidence in one another as the plan toward the new home**
- **2.7 They should always have at the back of their minds that they are not yet married; therefore they should not get physical involve with one another i.e. kissing, necking, petting and others related action that can stir up their emotion and lead to premarital sex. The sanctity of sex should be kept as a matter of spiritual maturity**
- **2.8 Those who discontinue their relationship should wait for at least 6month before entering a fresh relationship. Ending a relationship should not end in backbiting, bitterness and resentment in the spirit of Christian love.**

3.0 STEP FOR CORRECTION:

3.1 The offender can receive spiritual assistance via counseling from the family life ministries
The church i.e. pregnancy before marriage, proven cases of premarital sex.

3.2 Suspension for at least 3 month from his/her respective ministries in case they are workers.

3.3 Should the offence be by a church leader, he/her shall be received of the post immediately.

3.4 The offender shall not leave the church, but shall sit in the congregation and not minister during the period of suspension.

3.5 The congregation shall be notified of the offence and sanctions from the pulpit (1Tim 5:20)

3.6 These sanctions are subject to periodical review as and when due by the church board

4.0 STEP TO MARRIAGE:

4.1 The intending couple should be emotionally balance and mature enough to start a home e
They should be ready for responsibilities that come with it.

4.2 They should be financial capable to run their home. They should both be working and must have Basic things in place i.e a good and conducive accommodation with basic amenities.

4.3 They must seek and obtain parental approval before fixing the wedding date, time and venue, court and registry procedure carrying along their supervising counselor.

4.4 Supervising counselor must be notified and give the approval before any registry procedures and other ceremonies REGISTRY/TRADITIONAL/CHURCH/WEDDING CEREMONY.

4.5 The chosen date must be accepted by their senior pastor

4.6 The actual date of wedding must be forward to the senior Pastor at least 3 month to the wedding after which the couples are expected to have completed their marriage mentoring program.

4.7 The intending couple must have attended and completed all required classes and counseling sessions before fixing the wedding ceremonies.

4.8 In the case where the brother is not a member of Daystar, a letter of recommendation and approval of the wedding must be forwarded by his Pastor directly to the Pastor (Family Life Ministries) of DCC at least 4 months to the wedding.

4.9 Rehearsal sessions will be conducted for intending couples getting married in Daystar.

4.10 Where any of the above steps are not complied with, the Church/Pastors will not participate in the wedding ceremony procedures.

5.0 INVOLVEMENT OF THE CHURCH IN THE WEDDING

5.1 Make available sound counseling teaching and mentoring classes for all intending couples based on God's Biblical pattern for marriage.

5.2 Post wedding counseling session will be made available to couples up till 3 months after their wedding and as the need arises in marriage.

5.3 The church will be committed in the conduct of the marriage service only, while the intending couples are responsible for the reception as agreed with their families.

5.4 The wedding date will be announced in the Church a weeks before the actual wedding date.

5.5 Upon this announcement, relevant ministries in the Church will be on duty in the auditorium as at other services to add colures to the ceremony.

5.6 The church will be represented at approved wedding ceremonies by pastors, zonal leaders, unit members and the Family Life Ministries members.

5.7 The Church through the Family Life Ministries shall make available from time to time counseling on marriage and family life related matters as required by the couple